

Prompting with purpose, not generic AI output.

Two hours of hands-on practice: images, intention, spreadsheets, public-data research, operational efficiency, market monitoring, and a working one-file tool.

THE LESSON	AI fills in what you leave blank. Generic input produces the average.
THE HABIT	Say who it is for, why it is needed, what evidence may be used, and what must be reviewed.
THE BOUNDARY	Practice uses synthetic files. Sensitive company information never goes into an unapproved tool.
THE FINISH	A person checks the names, numbers, sources, formulas, claims, and commitments before anything leaves the screen.

Five rules to remember

- AI fills in what you leave blank.
- AI is not a calculator.
- AI cannot forecast lumber prices.
- If a number cannot be traced to a source, do not use it.
- A person signs off.

Governance rule

Never paste private landowner, customer, pricing, safety, employee, or proprietary information into an unapproved AI tool.

Session resources

Participant page: [kretz_prompting_session_2.html](#)
Practice files: [kretz_session_2_practice_datasets.zip](#)
Prompt pack: [kretz_session_2_practice_datasets/session2_prompt_pack.md](#)
Timber Sale Tracker example: [kretz_prompt_to_tool_builder_example.html](#)

Activities 1–3 · Specificity and intention

The first three activities make the central lesson visible: generic prompts produce generic output; details and purpose remove wrong answers.

1 · Bowl of fruit

RUN TOGETHER

Create an image of a bowl of fruit.

Compare the screens. Circle the details that appear repeatedly: bowl material, fruit selection, lighting, camera angle, and background. What did the tool decide because nobody told it otherwise?

2 · House in Wisconsin

GENERIC

Create an image of a house in Wisconsin.

STRUCTURED

Create a realistic image of a house in Wisconsin using: house style, exterior color, roof, setting, season, time of day, yard details, and purpose. Do not include address, license plates, mailbox numbers, or identifying personal details.

CORRECTION LOOP

Keep everything exactly as it is, but change the siding from white to tan, remove the porch swing, and move the garage to the left side of the house.

My house prompt notes

Style/era		Exterior color/material	
Roof		Setting/season	
Yard/features		Camera/purpose	

3 · Same house, different reason

FOR A CHILD

Transform the same house into a black-and-white coloring page for a child.

FOR A REMODEL CONVERSATION

Transform the same house into an architectural concept image for a remodel conversation.

The word “for” does real work.
Tell the tool who will use the output and what happens next. Purpose often changes the format more than extra adjectives do.

Activity 4 · Spreadsheets by prompt

Use spreadsheet_builder_haul_costs_synthetic.csv. The file contains four planted problems so the review lesson has something real to catch.

BUILD THE PLAN

Create a spreadsheet plan for tracking haul costs. Include columns, sample rows, formulas, cost per mile, cost per MBF, assumptions, and review warnings.

ASK FOR FORMULAS

Now give me the actual Excel formulas in the cells – do not give me the calculated numbers. Flag anything you had to assume.

TEACH ME BACK

Looking back at everything we just built together, how could I have gotten all of this from a single prompt? Write me that prompt, then explain which parts of it were doing the work.

AI is not a calculator.
Use it to propose structure, formulas, and analysis methods. Make it show its work, let Excel perform the arithmetic, and verify the result.

Find the four planted problems

Load	What should be caught?	Why it matters
HL-1007	board_feet = 0	Cost per MBF would divide by zero.
HL-1014	fuel_gallons is blank	Fuel cost can silently disappear.
HL-1020	3 miles to Stevens Point	Destination and mileage do not make sense together.
HL-1023	driving_hours = 26.5	The row requires review before any compliance conclusion.

Reference workbook: kretz_haul_costs_reference_workbook.xlsx

Activity 5 · Landowner research boundaries

Research where public records live, verify the current source, then practice on fictional parcel-shaped records.

SHOT 1 — FIND THE DATA

How can I find all the landowners in a single Wisconsin county using free, public data? I want owner names, mailing addresses, and acreage. Tell me exactly where that data lives, who publishes it, what format it comes in, what it costs, and how current it is.

SHOT 2 — NARROW IT

Now narrow it down. I only want private forested parcels big enough to be worth a conversation about timber. In Wisconsin parcel data, which field tells me a parcel is forest land, and what are the actual class codes? What acreage threshold makes sense, and why? Also explain how Managed Forest Law enrollment works and what its minimum acreage requirements are.

SHOT 3 — ADD THE FORESTRY LAYER

Where do I get Managed Forest Law spatial data for Wisconsin, and how would I join it to the county parcel data? Give me the portal, the layer name, and the field I would join on. Tell me plainly what parts of MFL are published publicly and what parts are not.

SYNTHETIC PRACTICE

Using the synthetic landowner research CSV, create a verification checklist and a careful outreach draft. Do not estimate timber value, imply Kretz inspected the property, or treat public data as verified.

Public does not mean anything goes.

The statewide layer is a snapshot, not a legal survey. Verify current county records, follow approved outreach practices, avoid protected or suppressed records, give recipients a respectful way to decline future contact, and require human review.

Verification checklist

- ☐ Current owner and mailing address confirmed by the county or municipality
- ☐ Acreage and property class checked
- ☐ MFL/FCL status and dates verified from an authoritative source
- ☐ No timber value, inspection, harvest recommendation, or commitment invented
- ☐ Message reviewed and signed by a qualified person

Activities 6–8 · Decide, monitor, and build

6 · Operational efficiency

CLASSIFY FIRST

Using the operational efficiency CSV, classify each task as existing software first, narrow Custom GPT, automation, process cleanup, vendor system, or do not use AI yet.

ADD CONSTRAINTS

Now redo the top three with my actual constraints: who is on shift, what equipment is down, and what has a hard deadline this week. If a constraint makes your recommendation wrong, say so instead of working around it.

7 · Price movement scenarios

ANALYZE

Using the synthetic lumber price movement data, identify patterns and possible leading indicators. Do not make a prediction as fact. Give scenarios, assumptions, confidence, and source-verification needs.

MONITORING TEMPLATE

Now turn that into a one-page monitoring template: the drivers worth tracking, where each number comes from, how often to check it, and what a meaningful change looks like versus normal noise. Use only what is in the data I gave you. If something is not in it, say so rather than filling it in.

AI cannot forecast lumber prices.
Use it to organize supplied evidence and build monitoring scenarios—not to invent the next price.

8 · Build a tiny HTML tool

BUILD

Build a single-file HTML tool to help with this problem: [describe problem]. It should have inputs, output, review warning, no external dependencies, and a print button. Ask up to five questions before coding if needed.

REFINE

Two changes only. [First change.] [Second change.] Leave everything else exactly as it is.

My tool request

The problem in one sentence	
Who uses it	
What goes in	
What comes out	
Constraints	Single file / offline / no login / other:

What must be reviewed	
Two refinements only	1. 2.

A prototype is not a production system.
Before operational use, decide ownership, testing, access, persistence, maintenance, data rules, and human review.

Final review

- ☐ Audience and purpose are clear
- ☐ Names, dates, numbers, formulas, sources, and commitments are checked
- ☐ Unsupported claims are removed
- ☐ Approved tools and approved data only
- ☐ A person signs off